

OIL PAINTING

LAY IN The initial painting stage over a preliminary drawing where the colors are applied as broad areas of flat color. This technique is also known as blocking in.

LIGHTFASTNESS The permanence or durability of a color.

LINSEED OIL A vegetable drying oil from the seeds of the flax plant used as a binding material in oil color. Linseed oil is the most commonly used oils and it dries more quickly than semidrying oils. The oil does not dry by evaporation but forms a solid film.

LOW-KEY COLOR Subdued, unsaturated color that tends toward brown and gray. Tertiary colors are low-key in appearance and produce neutral hues similar in mood and tone.

MAHL STICK A bamboo or aluminum stick about 4ft (1.25m) long with a ball-shaped end. If you paint with your right hand, the stick is held with the left hand, with the ball end touching the canvas so that the right hand can rest on the stick while painting. This helps hold your hand steady if you need to work on a particular area.

MASKING TAPE Pressure-sensitive tape used to protect areas from paint.

MEDIUM The binding material or "vehicle" for pigment in a paint system. In oil paint, a vegetable drying oil such as linseed oil is the medium. An oil painting medium is used to modify the consistency of oil paint in techniques such as glazing. A typical oil painting medium is made up of a mixture of stand oil (linseed oil that has been boiled) and turpentine.

MONOPRINT A unique print taken from a work created on a slab of glass or laminate.

OIL STICKS A type of oil paint blended with waxes in the form of sticks and applied directly to the canvas. Colors can be modified with a piece of cloth or a finger. Oil sticks, unlike other drawing materials, are extremely creamy in texture and are good for working wet-in-wet.

OPAQUE PAINTING Paintings that use predominantly opaque paints and the techniques associated with them.

OPTICAL MIX When a color is arrived at by the visual effect of overlaying or abutting distinct colors, rather than by physically mixing them on a palette.

PERSPECTIVE The method of representing a three-dimensional object on a two-dimensional surface. Linear perspective makes objects appear smaller as they get farther away by means of a geometric system of measurement.

PHTHALOCYANINE Modern organic transparent blue and green (chlorinated copper phthalocyanine) pigments of high tinting strengths and excellent lightfastness. Also known by trade names.

PHYSICAL MIX When a color is created by premixing two or more colors together on the palette before application to the support. Wet-in-wet and wet-on-dry techniques refer to mixing paints on the support itself.

PIGMENT A solid colored material, in the form of discrete particles, which forms the basic component of all types of paint. In oil painting, pigments are bound together with a semidrying or drying oil, such as linseed oil. Pigments come in different forms and the amount of oil used to coat each type of pigment will vary.

PLEIN AIR This term refers to painting in the open air. Alla prima techniques are normally used in this situation.

PRIMARY COLORS The three colors of red, blue, and yellow in painting that cannot be produced by mixing any other colors.

PRIMING This refers to the preliminary coating laid onto the support prior to painting. A layer of priming protects the support from any potentially damaging components of paint and provides the surface with the right key, absorbency, and color before painting.

RECEDING COLOR The perception of a color, usually a cool (blue), as being distant from the viewer.

REFRACTIVE INDEX A measure of the degree of refraction of a substance. The ratio between the angle of the incident ray in air with that of the refracted ray in the substance produces this measure.

SGRAFFITO A technique, usually involving a scalpel or a sharp knife, in which dried paint is scraped off the painted surface so that the color of the surface, or a dry color painted previously, is visible. This is often used for textural effects.

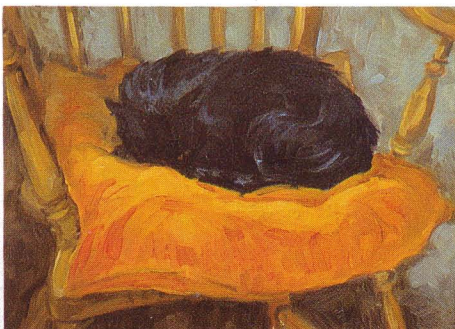
SABLE BRUSH Mink tail hair used to make fine brushes. Normally used in watercolor techniques, these brushes can also be used in oil painting for fine detailed brushwork or final touches and highlights.

SATURATION The degree of intensity of a color. Colors can be saturated, i.e., vivid and of intense hue, or unsaturated, i.e., dull, tending toward gray.

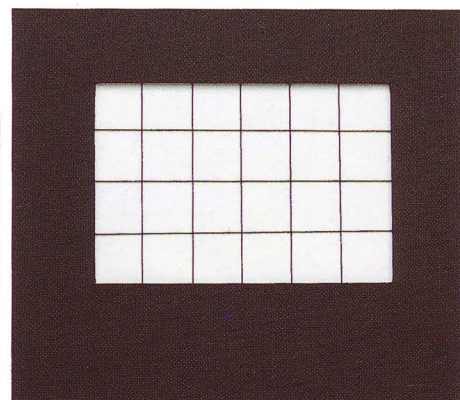
SCUMBLING A painting technique in which semi-opaque or thin opaque colors are



Ready-primed
canvas



Alla prima



Viewfinder